



Health & Safety Policy

Overleaf Publishers Ltd — Chainsaw Courses Platform

Document Ref	Version	Issue Date	Next Review
Health and Safety Policy	1.0	July 2026	July 2027

1 | Statement of Intent

Overleaf Publishers Ltd is committed to providing and maintaining a safe and healthy environment for all learners, staff, contractors, and visitors engaged with its vocational eLearning platform and associated activities. This commitment extends to the delivery of chainsaw safety training content and all operational aspects of the business.

The Directors of Overleaf Publishers Ltd accept overall responsibility for health and safety and will ensure that this policy is implemented, monitored, and reviewed annually or following any significant incident, organisational change, or revision to relevant legislation.

2 | Scope & Application

This policy applies to:

- All persons employed by or contracted to Overleaf Publishers Ltd
- Learners accessing the chainsawcourses.com platform and associated physical training activities
- Authors, content developers, and platform administrators
- Any third-party organisations engaged in delivery or assessment activities on behalf of the company
- All premises, vehicles, and remote working locations used in connection with business activities

3 | Legal Framework

This policy has been developed in compliance with the following legislation and guidance:

Legislation / Standard	Application
Health & Safety at Work Act 1974	Overarching duty of care to employees, learners and visitors
Management of Health & Safety at Work Regulations 1999	Risk assessment, planning, monitoring and review obligations
Provision & Use of Work Equipment Regulations 1998 (PUWER)	Safe use and maintenance of all work equipment including chainsaws
Lifting Operations & Lifting Equipment Regulations 1998 (LOLER)	Safe use of lifting equipment on arboricultural sites
Personal Protective Equipment at Work Regulations 2022	Provision, maintenance and use of appropriate PPE
Manual Handling Operations Regulations 1992	Assessment and reduction of manual handling risks
Reporting of Injuries, Diseases & Dangerous Occurrences Regulations 2013 (RIDDOR)	Statutory incident reporting obligations
Control of Noise at Work Regulations 2005	Management of noise exposure during chainsaw operation
Control of Vibration at Work Regulations 2005	Management of hand-arm vibration from chainsaw use
Work at Height Regulations 2005	Safe working at height in arboricultural contexts
First Aid at Work Regulations 1981 (as amended)	Provision of adequate first-aid cover on operational sites

HSE Arboriculture & Forestry Advisory Group (AFAG) Series	Sector-specific guidance on chainsaw and arboricultural safety
IIRSM Code of Conduct & Course Approval Standards	Compliance with approved training provider obligations
RoSPA Qualifications Standards Framework	Quality assurance in vocational health and safety training

4 | Responsibilities

4.1 Managing Director / Author

- Establishing, implementing, and reviewing this health and safety policy
- Ensuring adequate resources are allocated for health and safety management
- Ensuring all course content accurately reflects current HSE guidance and legislation
- Conducting and documenting risk assessments for all operational activities
- Investigating accidents, incidents, and near-misses and implementing corrective actions
- Maintaining current First Aid at Work certification
- Ensuring personal chainsaw qualifications (NPTC 0039-20) are kept current

4.2 Learners

- Complying with health and safety instructions provided within the training platform
- Not undertaking any practical chainsaw activities without appropriate training and qualifications
- Reporting any safety concerns, platform errors, or inaccuracies in training content to the company
- Ensuring they hold appropriate qualifications before operating chainsaws in a professional capacity
- Using all required PPE as specified within the training materials

4.3 Content Contributors & Contractors

- Complying with all applicable health and safety legislation relevant to their activities
- Alerting Overleaf Publishers Ltd to any safety-critical content inaccuracies
- Maintaining relevant qualifications and competency for any specialist input provided

5 | Risk Assessment

Overleaf Publishers Ltd will conduct documented risk assessments for:

- Content creation activities including video production and on-site demonstration filming
- Remote working environments used by staff and contractors
- Any live assessor or demonstration activities connected with course development
- Display screen equipment (DSE) used by platform development and administration staff

Risk assessments will be reviewed annually, following any incident, or when working conditions change. All learners are directed to conduct site-specific risk assessments before undertaking any practical chainsaw activities, using the Dynamic Risk Assessment tool embedded in the platform.

6 | Accident Reporting & Investigation

All accidents, incidents, near-misses, and unsafe conditions must be reported to the Managing Director immediately. Records will be maintained in accordance with RIDDOR 2013. Where a reportable incident occurs, notification will be made to the HSE within the statutory timeframes. All incidents will be investigated to identify root causes and prevent recurrence.

7 | Training & Competency

All persons involved in the creation and delivery of chainsaw training content hold, or are supervised by persons holding, current and appropriate vocational qualifications. The Managing Director holds City & Guilds NPTC 0039-20, a current First Aid at Work certificate, and has over 27 years of practical industry experience as a chainsaw operator, NPTC assessor, and LANTRA instructor. Competency records are maintained and reviewed annually.

8 | Emergency Procedures

In the event of an emergency connected with any operational activity:

1. Ensure personal safety and the safety of others — do not put yourself at risk
2. Dial 999 and request appropriate emergency services
3. Administer first aid if qualified to do so and it is safe
4. Do not move an injured person unless there is immediate risk to life

5. Notify the Managing Director as soon as it is safe to do so
6. Preserve the scene for investigation purposes where possible
7. Record all details in the incident log within 24 hours

9 | Policy Review

This policy will be reviewed annually (next review: July 2027), following any significant incident, or in response to changes in legislation, HSE guidance, or business operations. The current version is available to all learners and stakeholders via the chainsawcourses.com platform.